

Physical Characteristics of Minerals

A mineral is an _____ substance found naturally on the Earth's crust. All minerals are _____ but not all _____ are minerals.

Inorganic means _____
_____

Crystals are _____
_____

Minerals can be characterised by their physical properties:

1. **Colour**: Explain how colour can be used to identify minerals. _____
_____
_____

Green and blue often indicate _____ whilst red usually indicates _____.
Is colour a good way to identify minerals? Why? _____
_____

2. **Streak:** This is the colour of the _____ mineral. This colour can be quite _____ from the parent rock.

Explain how you test for streak. _____
_____

Is streak the same as colour? _____

3. **Cleavage:** Explain what **cleavage in minerals** means. _____
_____

This is due to the bonding between molecules. _____ has one cleavage plane which breaks it into flat sheets. _____ pyrites (fool's gold) has six which break it into cubic prisms.

Draw some examples of different forms of **cleavage in minerals**.



4. **Magnetism:** Explain what magnetism means. _____
_____

How do you test for it? _____

5. **Lustre:** Explain what lustre is. _____
_____
_____
Describe three of the terms used to identify lustre. Eg earthy. _____
_____
_____

6. **Crystalline Habit:** Explain the crystalline habit of different minerals. _____
_____
_____
Draw three different crystal forms.

7. **Hardness:** Describe hardness of a mineral. _____
_____

Complete the Moh's Hardness Scale:

1	Talc	6	
2		7	
3		8	
4		9	Corundum
5		10	

8. **Specific Gravity:** Explain specific gravity. _____
_____
_____
_____
_____
_____



